

INTERMEDIATE GRAMMAR – 2

Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

The Chinese interest in Nalanda where Hiuen Tsang spent almost 12 years in the company of several thousand scholar-monks, could well help the town develop as a major tourist attraction and the building of the temple could be the final step to laying new roads and developing infrastructure.

- ☐ a) in developing as a major tourist attraction and the building of the temple should be the first step to laying new roads and developing infrastructure
- ☒ b) develop as a major tourist attraction and the building of the temple could be the final step to lay new roads and developing infrastructure (Your answer - ✖)
- ☐ c) develop as a major tourist attraction and the building of the temple could be the first step to laying new roads and developing infrastructure (Correct Answer - ✔)
- ☐ d) develop as a major tourist attraction because building of the temple could be the final step to laying new roads and developing information

Solution:

The sentence is about the Chinese interest in developing Nalanda because it is a place where Hieun Tsang, spent 12 years. Choice (A) is incorrect. The use of the word 'should' makes it obligatory that building of the temple is required to lay new roads. In choice (B) the word 'final' changes the meaning of the paragraph. Choice (D) uses the words 'because' and 'final' which change the meaning of the statement. Choice (C) is the best option.

Choice (C)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

Researchers from Harward University estimate if artificially produced transfats have to be removed from American diet, up to 2,28,000 heart attacks could be prevented each year.

☒ a) is removed from American diet, up to 2,28,000 heart attacks could be prevented each year. (Your answer - ❌)

☐ b) had been removed from American diet, up to 2,28,000 heart attacks could be prevented each year.

☐ c) were removed from American diet, up to 2,28,000 heart attacks could be prevented. (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) has to be removed from American diet, up to 2,28,000 heart attacks could be prevented each year.

Solution:

The sentence is about transfats and how it is leading to an increase in the number of heart attacks. In choice (A) simple present is used in if clause which makes the sentence incorrect. Choice (B) uses past perfect which is also incorrect. Choice (D) uses present perfect which is also incorrect. It is choice (C) which is grammatically correct.
Choice (C)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

My work has reflected not only my physical journeys, but also my inner journeys as well.

☐ a) but also my inner journeys as well

☐ b) as well as my inner journeys also

☒ c) but my inner journeys as well (Your answer - ✔)

☐ d) as well my inner journeys also

Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

The population of Welsh village fuelled their cars on cooking oil and drove around without a problem.

☒ a) The population of Welsh village fuelled their cars (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) The population of Welsh village fuelled its cars

☐ c) The population of a Welsh village fuelled their cars

☐ d) The population of a Welsh village fuelled its cars (Correct Answer - ✔)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: In each of the following sentences a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

Archaeologists deal with things usually so broken as to be unrecognisable to the untrained eye, yet for them these objects reverberate people's lives.

☐ a) yet for them these objects reverberate with peoples' lives.

☒ b) yet for them these objects reverberate people's lives. (Your answer - ✔)

☐ c) yet for them these objects reverberate with people's lives.

☐ d) yet for them these objects reverberate on people's lives.

Directions for questions 6 to 8: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a) Since the time of ancient civilisations, ivory has been an object of great desire.
- (b) Ornaments and carvings have been fashioned out of ivory for centuries.
- (c) With the earliest items dating back to 20,000 years.
- (d) Ivory is extracted mostly from elephants in Africa and Asia.
- (e) Ivory products, desired over centuries, need to be banned in order with elephants to survive.

- ☐ a) Only c
- ☐ b) a and b
- ☐ c) c, d and e

☒ d) Only e (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

In sentence e, usage of 'order with' is incorrect, the correct usage must be 'order for'
The other sentences have no errors.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 6 to 8: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a) Comparing public sector banks with private and even foreign banks also are, perhaps, like comparing apples with oranges.
- (b) Public sector banks are regularly prodded and required to align its growth with the centre's objective.
- (c) The Indian branches of foreign banks, on the other hand, may lack control – since they are required to accept policy directions from the head office.
- (d) All banks do operate on the same terrain in the Indian banking sector.
- (e) Each bank has its own sets of levers, pulls and pressures.

☒ a) a and b (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) a and e
- ☐ d) b and e

Solution:

In sentence a the correct usage should be 'is'. In sentence b, usage of 'its' is incorrect, the correct usage must be 'their'. There are no errors in sentences a, d and e.

Choice (A)

Directions for questions 6 to 8: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a) The retail industry in India is estimated to be worth about \$ 500 billion.
- (b) Of this, currently, about 90 per cent of business was through local kirana or mom-and-pop stores.
- (c) Meanwhile, the Indian government can take comfort from the fact that Wal-Mart wants to continue its presence in India.
- (d) And wake up to the fact that not a single global brand to own up to 51 per cent of their local operations.
- (e) But no company has applied to enter under the rule.

☐ a) a and c

☒ b) Only b (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) Only d

☐ d) c, d and e

Solution:

In sentence b, usage of 'was' is incorrect, as the flow of the sentence is in present tense, the correct usage must be 'is'. All other sentences, i.e; a, c, d and e are free from errors.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 9 to 12: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- (a) Regenerative medicine the idea that it is possible to revitalise old, dilapidated tissue
(b) and keep a body going when its organs start to fail is attractive.
(c) Much effort thus has been put into creating and nurturing so-called pluripotent stem cells.
(d) These when appropriately nudged, can be induced to turn into cells of any other type.
(e) They might therefore be used for all sort of repairs.

☒ a) a and d (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) a, b and e
☐ c) a, b and d
☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

The expression 'the idea-----start to fail', is a parenthetical expression which gives additional information. The parenthesis is indicated by a dash after 'regenerative medicine' and after the expression 'start to fail'. In part b, the word fail should be followed by a dash, indicating the end of the parenthesis. Part c is erroneous due to the inappropriate positioning of the adverb 'thus'. The correction is '----- much effort has thus been put into-----'. In e the word 'sort' should be used in the plural, in keeping with the word 'repairs'. The correct expression is '----all sorts of repairs'. Only a and d are grammatically correct.
Choice (A)

Directions for questions 9 to 12: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- (a) Termites are synonymous for most people to destruction.
- (b) Given half a chance, they will chew up a house as soon as its owner's back is turned.
- (c) But entemologists have a different point of view.
- (d) They are more likely to wax lyrical about the insects talent for construction.
- (e) Termite mounds may reach as much as three metres towards the sky-quite an achievement for animals that are but a few millimetres long.

☐ a) b, c and d

☒ b) b and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) b, c and e

☐ d) c, d and e

Solution:

In statement a 'synonymous' should be followed by 'with' and not 'to' ---something is synonymous with something and not 'to'. In statement c the word 'entemologists' is misspelled. The correct spelling is 'entomologists'. In d, the word insects should be followed by an apostrophe, '----- insects' talent 'is the correct expression. Only b and e are error free.
Choice (B)

Directions for questions 9 to 12: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- (a) Poker, though luck is useful when playing it is essentially a game of skill.
- (b) Even betting on the horses means asesing the animals' form and the track's going.
- (c) But people who put money into slot machines might just as well stand there burning banknotes.
- (d) Not for nothing they were once known as one-armed bandits.
- (e) They mindlessly apply the laws of statistics to confiscate or pre-arranged proportion of the money put into them.

- ☐ a) a, b and c
- ☐ b) b, c and d
- ☐ c) b and c

☐ d) c and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

In a, the word playing should be followed by a comma because the expression 'though luck is useful when playing it' is a parenthetical expression which should be preceded and followed by a comma. In b, the word 'asesing' is wrongly spelt. The correct spelling is 'assessing'. In d the ordering of the words is incorrect. The correction is 'not for nothing were they once known'. Only c and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (D)

Directions for questions 9 to 12: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- (a) Elephants in Africa had been dealing with people since people existed,
(b) for the first humans evolved in that part of the world 2m years ago.
(c) And they have been dealing with honey bees even longer-for those insects, which also evolved in Africa, have been around for at least 35m years.
(d) People and bees are more or less the animals of which a full-grown elephant is scared of,
(e) So looking at the nuances of how they react to them is intriguing.

☐ a) a, b and d

☒ b) b, c and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) d and e

☐ d) b, c and d

Solution:

Part a, has a tense error. Since the reference is to an action which has relevance even to the present. The present perfect tense is more apt here. Therefore the sentence should read '.....have been'. In d, the 'of' after the word scared is incorrect or the sentence should be written as 'people and bees are more or less the only animals a full grown elephant is scared of'. Only b, c and e are correct. Choice (B)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each question consists of four sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- (a) As abstract concept that memory may seem to us, it is interesting to note that there are distinct biochemical phenomena underlying it.
- (b) Scientists have gained insight to the mechanism by which the brain is able to selectively retain some information as long-term memory.
- (c) Brain cells or neurons are connected to each other at points called 'synapses'.
- (d) The lifespan of a memory depends on how strong and long lasting these connections are which in turn depends on their chemical composition.

☐ a) b, c and d

☒ b) c and d (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) a, b and c

☐ d) a and b

Solution:

In statement a, the structure of the sentence is incorrect. The correction is 'As abstract a concept that memory'. In statement b, the word 'insight' should be followed by into. Statements c and d, are grammatically consistent. Choice (B)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each question consists of four sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- (a) India's diaspora of 25m people is something to behold.
- (b) In colonial times Indian labourers and traders spread around the world, from Fiji to the Caribbean.
- (c) A second wave of Indians left between the 1970's and mid-1990's, when the economy was in a semi-socialist rut.
- (d) Migrant workers rushed to the Arabian Gulf and South-east Asia, then booming.

- ☐ a) a and b
- ☐ b) b, c and d
- ☐ c) a, c and d

☒ d) a and d (Correct Answer - ✓)

Solution:

In statement b, the word 'spread' should be followed by across, in order to make the sentence grammatically correct. In statement c, the use of the possessive case in the figures 1970s and 1990 is incorrect. The correction is 1970s and 1990s. Statements a and d are correct statements.

Choice (D)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each question consists of four sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- (a) It is hard to tell the truth, still hard to accept it.
- (b) The truth by its very nature is neither polite nor palatable.
- (c) But for a country that equates the truth with victory, we seem to be intolerant of it increasingly.
- (d) A growing conservatism seems to be upon us with the intention to reduce our ability to debate, argue and differ.

☐ a) a and c

☒ b) b and d (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) a, b and c

☐ d) a, b and d

Solution:

Statement (a) is incorrect because here the adjective 'hard', when it is mentioned for the second time, should be in the comparative degree, because a comparison is made here. Therefore the correction here, is 'It is hard, harder still to accept it'. In statement c the adverb 'increasingly' is inappropriately placed. Therefore the correction is '.... we seem to be increasingly intolerant of it'. Statements b and d are grammatically correct.

Choice (B)